Andrew W. Shenstone

Shenstone, Andrew - Application for Senior Software Engineer, Frontend @ Customer.io

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SUMMARY

Senior engineer with 12+ years focused on React/TypeScript products, complex admin workflows, and craft-level UI. Customer.io's work—behavioral data powering email, push, in-app, and SMS that people actually want—lines up with my background in martech- and commerce-adjacent integrations, long-lived operator tools, and founder-owned product delivery at Plantfolio. I think like a user: accessibility, performance, and design systems that scale. I touched Ember.js in early client work at Ply Interactive when the framework was new; it's not my recent daily stack, but it's not alien, and I'm comfortable ramping in a codebase where React and Ember coexist. I like ownership, async collaboration, and using AI thoughtfully to ship faster without cutting corners on quality.

SKILLS

Frontend: TypeScript, React, Next.js, JavaScript (modern), HTML & CSS, Tailwind CSS, Shadcn UI, Ember.js (early professional use at Ply; would re-ramp; eager to pair with experts)

Product & craft: Accessible, performant UI, Design systems & reusable components, Complex workflows simplified for end users, Collaboration with design and product

Testing & quality: Vitest, Cypress, Practical unit, integration, and E2E coverage

Ways of working: Ownership across ambiguity (including founder-led delivery), Pairing, code review, and mentoring (Bloom, Tilia), AI-assisted development (Cursor power user) for speed and better tradeoffs

Backend: Node.js, PostgreSQL, Prisma, Server Actions, API Design

Architecture & async: Monorepos, Async workflows (Inngest, webhooks, background jobs), ETL pipelines, Performance optimization

Cloud & Tools: AWS (S3, EC2), Vercel, Algolia, Inngest, Clerk Auth, Stripe, Git, CI/CD, pnpm, Turbo, Cursor IDE (Top 1% user)

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Lead Engineer

Plantfolio | November 2023 - Present

Product Leadership & Architecture

- Architected and built a comprehensive plant management platform from the ground up, serving as both technical lead and product owner
- Owned the full feature cycle: joined customer calls to identify friction points, architected solutions, implemented, tested, and verified success in production
- Designed and implemented a sophisticated monorepo architecture with 12+ packages, enabling rapid development and maintainable codebases
- Led product strategy and user experience decisions, making product micro-decisions and navigating ambiguity to deliver value iteratively

Technical Achievements

- AI Integration: Built advanced AI-powered features including plant identification from photos, contextual chatbot (Sage), and smart text extraction from plant tags using OpenAI's vision and language models
- Modern Frontend Architecture: Implemented Next.js with React, React Server Components, and TypeScript, achieving exceptional performance and developer experience
- Complex Data Modeling: Designed and implemented sophisticated PostgreSQL schemas with Prisma, handling complex relationships between users, plants, folios, and media with 15+ interconnected models
- Content Management: Created sophisticated content management system with rich text editing, plant tagging, and flexible data structures

Scale & Performance

- Managed a database of 40,000+ plant species with advanced search capabilities using Algolia and vector embeddings
- Implemented comprehensive media management system with AWS S3, supporting image optimization, galleries, and metadata extraction
- Built robust authentication and authorization systems with Clerk, supporting multiple user types and subscription tiers
- Optimized application performance through React Server Components, efficient data fetching, and strategic caching

Client Case Study - AI Signage

- Delivered a production rollout for an independent garden center to automate plant signage generation; one independent retail customer in ongoing production who has been an enthusiastic reference
- Enabled bulk plant import (plain text) to printable signs in seconds; reduced a weekend-long manual process to minutes after initial setup
- Demonstrated ability to translate customer requirements into scalable technical solutions and shorten feedback loops

Full-Stack Ownership

- Developed complete payment integration with Stripe, subscription management, and user onboarding flows
- Built comprehensive email system with React Email, supporting transactional emails, notifications, and marketing campaigns
- Implemented advanced search and filtering capabilities with Algolia, supporting complex plant queries and user preferences

Code Quality & Leadership

- Established coding standards and architectural patterns that enabled rapid, consistent development
- Implemented comprehensive testing strategy with Vitest and Cypress, maintaining high code quality

- Built reusable component library and design system, ensuring consistent UI/UX across the platform

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Senior Software Engineer

Tilia | January 2023 - August 2023

- Partnered with cross-functional teams in product and design to revamp critical user-facing features
- Spearheaded and guided a team through the successful adoption of Chakra UI, reducing bespoke components and establishing cohesive design patterns
- Mentored engineers through pairing and code review in an informal technical lead capacity (no direct reports)
- Maintained exceptional unit test coverage of over 90% for the Tools team application, alongside comprehensive end-to-end testing
- Led the swift creation and deployment of a homepage reporting dashboard within the initial two months of joining
- Role ended in a company-wide layoff affecting approximately one-third of employees

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Senior Software Engineer

Bloom.wine | September 2020 - October 2022

- Architected a greenfield Next.js application for the primary admin interface of the Bloom product; much of that stack remains in production across many winery clients today
- Engineered Ruby on Rails GraphQL API endpoints shared by multiple applications across mobile and web devices
- Mentored engineers through pairing and code review in an informal technical lead capacity (no direct reports)

- Collaborated with designers using Figma, establishing component library standards usable by both engineering and design
- Integrated DatoCMS and extended application functionality through third-party API integrations (Shopify, Mailchimp, Stripe, Shipstation, ActiveCampaign)

Software Engineer II

Tune Inc - Marketplace Automation | August 2019 - May 2020

- Built and operated ETL-style data pipelines and integrations supporting marketplace automation workflows
- Automated a client workflow using a Node.js/Express API and React.js, reducing the time to complete the task from 10-15 minutes to 10-30 seconds
- Modernized the primary legacy React.js application by moving from a custom Webpack process to react-scripts, resulting in a 50% reduction in production build size and a 60% reduction in NPM dependencies
- Reduced development machine CPU usage from 75% to <5% by simplifying the build pipeline and dependency graph
- Role ended in a company-wide layoff

Software Developer

Ply Interactive Inc | June 2014 - July 2019

- Developed numerous web applications including The Washington State Fair (sustained multi-year production; very high traffic during fair season), Georgetownbeer.com, WashingtonWine.org, TwoWolvesWine.com, Novaerus.com, WellAir, and Plasma-air.com
- Built a standalone Ruby gem Content Management System, enabling simplified content management within Ruby on Rails projects
- Transitioned the agency to modern technologies like GraphQL, Gatsby.js, and React.js, improving delivery times for new projects

- Bloom.wine Product Development: Built extensive reporting features using complex PostgreSQL queries and interactive filtering, saving clients thousands of hours on previously manual tasks
- Engineered a flexible Wine Club membership structure for wineries, allowing for diverse client configuration and broadening the range of potential sales targets
- Communicated and enforced the standards of Shopify's Polaris React.js component library with designers, resulting in efficiencies gained from leveraging pre-built components

COMPANY REFERENCE

Plantfolio (2023-Present) - AI-powered plant management platform with 40,000+ plant database serving both consumer garden management and independent garden center services - plantfolio.garden/

Tilia (2023) - All-in-one payment platform for digital economies - tilia.io/

Bloom.wine (2020-2022) - Leader in commerce services for the alcohol industry - bloom.wine/

Tune Inc - Marketplace Automation (2019-2020) - SaaS platform for managing marketing partnerships across mobile and web - tune.com/

Ply Interactive Inc (2014-2019) - Boutique agency specializing in pixel-perfect custom websites and mobile applications; developed Bloom.wine product internally (2017-2019)